to all human activity. “We witness the spirit of the scientific world-conception penetrating in growing measure the forms of personal and public life,” the manifesto boldly claimed, “in education, upbringing, architecture, and the shaping of economic and social life according to rational principles.” The Circle’s members forged connections with artistic and social movements that shared a similar ethos, like the Bauhaus school of architecture and design. And the Circle also had politics to match its revolutionary rhetoric. Its philosophical opponents, like the German idealists, often had regressive right-wing politics. Heidegger, for example, was a staunch nationalist and agrarian traditionalist, who saw industrialization as a dehumanizing force. He urged a return to traditional cultural values, set himself against modern trends like representative democracy, and ultimately joined the Nazi Party in 1933. The Vienna Circle thought the horrors of the political far right went along with the unscientific and outmoded philosophies that the circle was fighting against. The members saw themselves in the tradition of the great Enlightenment empiricist philosophers such as Hume and Locke, and promoted Enlightenment values: international cooperation over nationalism, reason over faith, humanism over fascism, and democracy over authoritarianism. They saw industrialization not as an oppressive force, but as a modernizing one. The Vienna Circle believed these political causes were intimately connected to its philosophical work. Neurath, for example, had been the economist for the short-lived revolutionary socialist Bavarian state in 1919, and he was nearly sent to prison for his troubles. “Endeavours toward a new organization of economic and social relations, toward the unification of mankind, toward a reform of school and education, all show an inner link with the scientific world-conception,” he wrote in the Vienna Circle’s manifesto. “The representatives of the scientific world-conception resolutely stand on the ground of simple human experience. They confidently approach the task of removing the metaphysical and theological debris of millennia.”

True to their humanist and internationalist politics, Schlick and his colleagues reached out to the world. “The Vienna Circle does not confine itself to collective work as a closed group,” their manifesto declared. “It is also trying to make contact with the living movements of the present, so far as they are well disposed toward the scientific world-conception and turn